

YU, Xiaofei

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Environmental and energy policy evaluation; energy transition and climate governance; central–local relations and campaign-style governance in China; China–Middle East energy and economic relations; causal inference for public policy.

EDUCATION

The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

2022.09 – 2024.07

Master of Public Policy | CGA: 4.06 / 4.30

- Honors: Asian Future Leaders Scholarship (2022–2024); Academic Excellence Scholarship
- Relevant coursework: Policy Impact Evaluation (A+); Quantitative Analysis and Empirical Methods (A+); Environmental Economics (A+); Advanced Analytical Methods for Public Policy (A); Environmental Politics and Policy (A); Policy Analysis Excercise – Capstone (A)

Fudan University

2018.09 – 2022.06

Bachelor of Management in Public Administration | GPA: 3.55 / 4.00

Second Major (Minor): Translation Between English and Chinese | GPA: 3.56 / 4.00

- Relevant coursework: Quantitative Research Methods (A); Method of Public Policy Analysis (A); Introduction to International Relations (A); Introduction to Mediterranean Studies (A); Introduction to Arab-Islamic Culture (B+); Modern Hebrew I–II (B+)

PUBLICATION

(Co-author) Chen, Xing, and **Yu, Xiaofei**. 2023. “The Emission-Reduction Effect of China’s Carbon Trading Market: An Empirical Analysis Based on the Synthetic Control Method” [中国碳交易市场的减排效果：基于合成控制法的实证分析]. *Fudan Public Administration Review* 26: 207–240. (In Chinese; CSSCI)

- Reviewed the institutional design, trading activity and performance of China’s seven regional ETS pilots; applied the synthetic control method to estimate their CO₂ reduction effects by region and industry
- Found that the more active pilots (Hubei, Shenzhen, Guangdong) achieved significant reductions, and that in Hubei, emissions fell in the ferrous and non-ferrous metals industries but not in power

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Does China’s “Coal-to-Gas” Policy Boost Natural Gas Consumption? Evidence from a PSM-DID Analysis

Term Paper | HKUST, Advanced Analytical Methods for Public Policy (A)

2024.03 – 2024.05

- Built a 281-city panel (2014–2020) and combined propensity score matching with difference-in-differences and an event study to evaluate the “2+26” cities program
- Found that natural gas consumption fell by 28% in treated cities, an effect that grew each year after the policy began (SDID robustness check: –33%); traced the result to implementation failures such as supply and equipment shortages and cost surges

Performance Evaluation of Collaborative Air-Pollution Governance in China: The Blue-Sky Protection Campaign

Undergraduate Thesis (Grade A; in Chinese) | Fudan University | Supervisor: Assoc. Prof. ZHOU Lingyi

2021.09 – 2022.05

- Applied synthetic difference-in-differences to a 240-city panel (2013–2020) and found significant PM_{2.5} reductions in all three key regions, largest in Jing-Jin-Ji and surrounding areas (–4.8 µg/m³); confirmed with province-level placebo tests
- Identified three channels through which central (hierarchical) intervention improves collaborative governance: task distribution, supervision, and additional resources

ESG Compliance and Regulatory Gaps: Strengthening Hong Kong Listed Companies’ ESG Reporting Capacity

Capstone Project (Grade A) | HKUST & Alaya Consulting | Supervisor: Prof. YARIME Masaru

2023.09 – 2024.05

- Led a six-member team commissioned by an ESG consultancy to assess Hong Kong-listed companies’ readiness for HKEX’s new ISSB-aligned climate disclosure requirements
- Reviewed the ESG reports of the Corporate Knights Global 100 and conducted semi-structured interviews with listed-company ESG staff, government regulators and ESG experts
- Proposed a two-stage policy package: first capacity building, then report quality through assurance subsidies, sampling inspections and penalties

Did the COVID-19 Pandemic Affect People’s Belief in Hard Work? Evidence from Guangdong

Course Research Paper | HKUST

2023.03 – 2023.04

- Analyzed telephone survey data ($N \approx 1,860$) from six Guangdong cities using linear probability models; respondents hit hard by the pandemic were 5.4 percentage points more likely to value luck and guanxi over hard work

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Bai Xian Asia Institute | Senior Associate | Hong Kong

2024.10 – Present

- Lead a team that runs the Asian Future Leaders Scholarship Program, which awards up to 100 scholarships a year across 10 partner universities in 7 Asian cities; monitor program operations and keep them on schedule

- Project-manage the annual three-week Summer Program, which brings all scholars to one Asian city: design the academic program and manage guest speakers, including professors, business leaders and diplomats
- Build the scholar and alumni community: manage alumni chapters in 7 Asian cities and run the Bai Xian Project Award (funding for scholar-led social innovation and East Asia research projects) and the Bai Xian Peer Mentoring Program
- Manage the operating budget and the Summer Program budget

Huawei Technologies Co., Ltd. | HR Intern | Shenzhen

2021.07 – 2021.08

- Researched how firms use material and non-material incentives in internal referral programs, and planned an offline referral campaign for experienced candidates in the Finance Department

AWARDS

Finalist, HKUST Inter-University Public Policy Case Competition

2024.03 – 2024.04

- Analyzed Hong Kong's transitional housing policy for households on the long public rental housing waiting list (average wait: 5.8 years), and compared it with light public housing, social-bond financing, subdivided-unit regulation and the T-Home letting scheme on cost-effectiveness, equity and political feasibility
- Advanced from the poster round to the final and defended our policy recommendations before a judging panel

Second Prize, "Victoria Harbour 2035" Urban Planning Competition

2023.12 – 2024.05

- Co-designed a revitalization scheme for Chai Wan, including a deindustrialization plan, a coastal recreational zone and a multifunctional aquatic venue

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Mandarin Chinese (native); Cantonese (proficient); English (proficient); Modern Hebrew (elementary; two semesters of university coursework)
- **Research methods:** synthetic control; (synthetic) difference-in-differences; propensity score matching; event study; regression analysis of survey data; semi-structured interviews
- **Software:** Stata; Microsoft Office; Adobe Photoshop; Claude AI